1. Welcome

This handbook is for everyone who works at Nova Software. Nova Software is a fictional company; the rules here exist only for the examples in this course.

Working hours are flexible. Core hours are from 10:00 to 16:00; everyone must be reachable during these hours. You can start your day at any time between 08:00 and 10:00.

Remote work is allowed for at most two days a week. Tuesday and Thursday are office days; team meetings happen on these two days. You enter your remote days in the Compass system one day ahead.

The office is in Kadikoy, Istanbul. Twenty bicycle spaces in the car park are reserved for people who cycle to work. Visitor cards are picked up at reception and returned at the end of the day.

2. Annual leave

Your annual leave depends on your length of service. In your first five years, your annual leave is 18 working days. After you complete five years, your annual leave rises to 24 working days.

You enter your leave request in the Compass system at least ten working days in advance. Your manager approves or rejects the request within three working days. Leave that is not approved does not count as taken.

You can carry over at most five unused days to the next year. You must use the carried-over days by March 31; after that date, carried-over days are deleted.

You get one extra day of leave on your birthday. This leave is not deducted from your annual leave and is used within the week of your birthday.

3. Sick leave and special leave

When you are ill, you tell your manager before the working day starts. No doctor's note is needed for illnesses of up to two days. For illnesses of three days or longer, a note is required.

Special leave is not deducted from your annual leave. An employee who gets married receives five days, a new father receives ten days, and an employee who loses a close family member receives five days. There is one day of leave for moving house.

For special leave, you send the document to human resources within one week after the leave ends. If no document arrives, the days used are deducted from your annual leave.

4. Equipment and home office

Every employee receives a laptop, a monitor and a headset. The laptop is replaced every three years. Equipment belongs to the company and is returned when you leave.

If you lose your equipment or it is stolen, you tell the IT team within twenty four hours. The support address is support@nova.example.

The home office allowance is 500 dollars a year. You can use it for a chair, a desk or lighting. When you upload the invoice to the expense system, the amount is paid with your next salary.

5. Training and expenses

Every employee has a yearly training budget of 1,500 dollars. Courses, books and conference costs are paid from this budget. The budget resets at the end of the year and does not carry over.

Conferences abroad need approval from your manager and from human resources. After the conference, you give the team a half-hour summary presentation.

For an expense refund, you upload the invoice to the expense system within thirty days of the purchase. Invoices older than thirty days are not refunded.

On the days you work in the office, your meal card is topped up with 15 dollars a day. On the days you work remotely, the meal card is not topped up.